

COTA / First-Week Transit Card

For new riders and anyone rebuilding a car-light week.

Not affiliated with COTA. Fares, routes, and apps change — confirm in official tools before you go.

First-week setup

- ☐ Install official trip-planning / fare apps you actually need
- ☐ Save home pin + work/school pin offline screenshots
- ☐ Learn your nearest stop name (not just “by the coffee shop”)
- ☐ Buy/validate fare the way you’ll use it on a busy morning (test once)
- ☐ Identify a backup: rideshare · bike · different route

Nearest stop to home: _____

Nearest stop to work/school: _____

Route worksheet

Trip	Route # / name	Leave by	Arrive by	Transfer?
Home → work				
Work → home				
Home → grocery				
Home → weekend spot				

Weekday timing notes

- Build a **10–15 minute** buffer the first week
- Night and weekend frequencies often drop — check before late plans
- Weather: waterproof shoes beat clever jackets when you’re standing at a stop

Airport (CMH) planning blanks

Field	Yours
Flight time	
Need to be at curb/security by	
Transit option researched?	Y/N — details: _____
Backup rideshare budget	\$_____
Luggage reality (carry vs checked)	

Rider habits that reduce stress

- ☐ Headphones at half volume so you hear stop announcements
- ☐ Sit where you can see stop requests / doors

- ☐ Know the last reliable trip home before you go out
- ☐ Keep a folded paper this card + charger

What confused me week one: _____

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio

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